Nhill subscriptions: financial and marketing study

Français : ../fr/16-etude-financiere-abonnements.md

Version	1.0 — 27 October 2026
Status	**recommendations subject to the product owner's approval**: no price is published on the website or loaded into the database
Method	public prices collected online on 26 and 27 October 2026 (§ 15), inspection of the Nhill 2.1 code, reproducible financial model (`marketing/tools/subscription_model.py`)
Legend	**V** verified data, with its source and date; **H** assumption to validate; calculations are made by the script, never by hand
Calculation currency	US dollar (USD); 1 EUR = 1.149 USD (0.87 EUR per USD, August 2026 reading)

1. Executive summary

- **Recommended positioning**: Nhill is the all-in-one solution for freelancers, shops and SMEs that want to sell, take payments and follow their stock from the first day, with **one subscription per establishment** (not a licence per user) and support to get started. Against modular ERPs such as Odoo, the case is a quick start, everyday tools already connected and a predictable cost as the team grows.
- **Three plans** (Solo, Commerce, SME) plus a custom offer, built on the limits that already exist in the code (users, tills, warehouses). Proposed prices for **zone A** (low and lower-middle income countries, including the DRC): **$9, $25 and 59*amonth* * *,10*monthspaidforanannualsubscription.A* * *zoneB* * (*upper–middleandhighincome*)*at* * *15, $39 and $89** should only open after the compliance work specific to each target country.
- **Break-even**: with a minimal team (founder, one onboarding agent, one sales agent) and the current infrastructure, about **99 active customers** are needed in zone A (64 in zone B).
- **36-month scenarios**: lasting operating break-even in **month 23** in the central scenario (331 active customers in month 36, annual recurring revenue of about 92, 000), *month*15*intheoptimisticone*, *notreachedinthepessimisticone*.*Maximumcashneed* : * *27,500** (central) to **$58,100** (pessimistic).
- **What decides**: the number of demos (45 a month by month 12 in the central scenario), churn (every extra point is costly) and the price customers actually accept, to be measured during the pilot before anything is published.
- **Multi-currency**: one reference price list in USD, CDF, EUR, XAF/XOF lists derived by a published, reviewed rule, the billing currency chosen at sign-up; no automatic card or Mobile Money payment is announced until the integration is tested in real conditions.

2. The product and its target segments

2.1 What exists in Nhill 2.1 (code inspected)

Area	Available functions
Sales	quotes, orders, invoices, credit notes as PDF, partial payments, receivables per currency
Till (Nhill POS, Windows and Linux)	sessions, several payment methods per ticket, discounts and voids approved by a supervisor, blind cash count, variance, X and Z reports

Area	Available functions
Stock and purchasing	stock per warehouse, movements, threshold alerts, transfers, supplier purchases, expenses
Management	dashboard, PDF and CSV reports, tamper-proof activity log, roles per employee
Platform	Nhill Business on Windows, Linux and Android; English and French; ten currencies (USD, EUR, GBP, CHF, XAF, XOF, CDF, KES, RWF, ZAR); establishments isolated in the database
Subscriptions (Nhill Console)	plans with `max_users`, `max_registers`, `max_warehouses` limits, `multi_warehouse` option, audience (individual, company), prices **per duration (1, 3, 6, 12, 24, 36 months) and per currency**, promo codes, prorated credit when changing plan, 30-day trial (setting), 7-day grace period, read-only after suspension
Collecting subscriptions	manual payment instructions; Stripe (cards) and PayPal adapters **tested only against a local fake service**; Payoneer configured without an adapter

Out of scope today (to keep in mind for price and competition): general ledger, till on Android, sending documents directly by e-mail, connection to Mobile Money operators, tax certification in any country (the DRC profile is a draft to be validated; the international profile is generic).

2.2 Segments

Segment	Main need	What Nhill brings	Natural plan
Freelancer, solopreneur (service provider, craftsperson, consultant, small seller)	quotes, invoices, payments, knowing who owes what	invoices in their name, attached payments, expenses, Android phone	Solo
Small business, shop (2 to 5 people, one or two tills)	reliable till, accurate stock, control of sales staff	till with variance, automatic stock, roles, log	Commerce
SME (6 to 15 people, several tills or warehouses)	remote control, several sites, reports for the accountant	several warehouses and tills, reports, exports	SME
Larger or multi-establishment business	specific needs	on quote, several establishments under one account	Custom

DRC market data (market study, document 01): in a survey of 914 MSMEs, 51% use digital tools, but only 19% of equipped MSMEs have stock management software, and cost is the first barrier cited (54% of micro-enterprises). These figures guide the zone A price level; they do not measure willingness to pay.

3. Market and competition

3.1 Economic context of the launch zone (DRC)

Data	Value	Source (V)
World Bank classification (fiscal year 2027, 2025 gross national income per capita)	DRC and Rwanda: low income; Cameroon, Côte d'Ivoire, Senegal, Kenya, Nigeria, Congo-Brazzaville: lower-middle income; South Africa, Gabon: upper-middle income. Thresholds: low ≤ $1,175, lower-middle $1,176 to $4,635, upper-middle $4,636 to $14,375, high > $14,375	Afridigest, 8 July 2026, from the World Bank
Preference for the dollar	"préférence pour le dollar" noted by the IMF; $13.0 billion of dollar deposits in the banking system	IMF, country report No. 26/2, January 2026

Data	Value	Source (V)
Growth	real GDP: +5.6% in 2025, about +5.3% projected for 2026	IMF, country report No. 26/2 (table 1; year alignment to check in the PDF)
Exchange rate	1 USD = 2,264.0000 CDF (BCC official rate, 26/10/2026); 2,317.50 CDF (market, 23/10/2026), a 0.98% depreciation over a year	BCC (document 01, S3); Trading Economics

Consequence: a USD reference price matches the target's habits; a CDF list is still needed for those who pay in francs, with a review rule (§ 11).

3.2 Direct and indirect competitors

Solution	Category	Pricing model	Strengths	Where Nhill stands out
Odoo	modular ERP	per user per month, price list per country; one free application	very broad coverage (accounting, CRM, point of sale, manufacturing…)	guided start, everyday tools already connected, price per establishment
Zoho Books, Zoho Inventory	online accounting and stock	per organisation, users included per tier; free plan under a revenue threshold	full accounting, low prices, local price lists (Kenya)	integrated till with controls, stock and counter sales in the same tool
QuickBooks Online	accounting	per company, users per tier	accounting, accountant ecosystem	price suited to small businesses in zone A, till included
Sage Accounting (Africa)	accounting	per company, paid options (multi-currency, advanced stock)	African presence, USD prices in Kenya and Nigeria	multi-currency and stock included, till
Loyverse, Square	point of sale	free till, paid options per store	free to start, hardware	quotes, invoices, receivables, purchases, multi-currency in the same tool
Dolibarr (DoliCloud), ERPNext (Frappe Cloud)	hosted open-source ERPs	per user (DoliCloud) or flat (ERPNext)	open source, broad	ease of use, support, till with controls
Notebook, spreadsheet, local till software	current alternatives	free or licence	familiar, no subscription	traceability, remote follow-up, several workstations

Main threat: **free** offers (Odoo one application, Zoho Books free, Loyverse) at entry level. Response: Nhill does not win the Solo segment on price alone but on the complete tool (till + invoices + stock), simplicity and support; the Solo price must stay under the $10 psychological threshold.

4. Price and feature comparison

Public prices, excluding tax, in USD unless stated. Odoo data comes from third-party pages that reproduce odoo.com (the official page could not be read by our tools): **check on odoo.com from the contracting country** before any communication.

Solution and tier	Price collected	Users / limits	Till	Stock	Multi-currency	Source (date)
Odoo Standard, United States list	$24.90 per user per month in year 1, then $31.10 (annual); monthly +20 to 25%	per user	application included	yes	yes	ERP Research, July 2026; Cybrosys
Odoo Standard, “Sub-Saharan Africa” list	$8.95 per user per month (annual); Custom $13.60	per user	yes	yes	yes	OEC.sh, verified 18 October 2026
Odoo “One App Free”	$0	one application, unlimited users, no Studio or multi-company	if the chosen application is point of sale	no (other application)	—	Cybrosys
Zoho Books (United States)	free (revenue < $50,000), Standard $15 (annual) / $20, Professional $40 / $50, Premium $60 / $70; extra user $2.50 / $3	1, 3, 5, 10	no	from Professional	from Professional	zoho.com, 27/10/2026
Zoho Books (Kenya)	Standard KSh 849 (≈ $6.54), Professional KSh 1,699 (≈ $13.08), Premium KSh 2,499 (≈ $19.24) a month, annual	3, 5, 10	no	from Professional	from Professional	zoho.com/ke, 27/10/2026; 1 USD = KSh 129.907 on 26/10/2026
Zoho Inventory (United States, annual)	Standard $29, Premium $79, Plus $129, Enterprise $249; free: 50 orders	3 to 10; 2 to 10 locations	no	yes	—	zoho.com, 27/10/2026
QuickBooks Online (United States)	Simple Start $38, Essentials $85, Plus $140, Advanced $340 (−50% for three months on promotion)	1, 3, 5, 25	no	Plus	—	quickbooks.intuit.com, 27/10/2026
Sage Accounting (Kenya, Nigeria)	Start $12.33, Standard $23.67 a month; options in South Africa: multi-currency R185, advanced inventory R465 a month	1; 2 (up to 5)	no	option	option	sage.com/africa, 27/10/2026
Loyverse	free till; employee management $25, advanced inventory 25*perstorepermonth*(250 a year each)	per store	yes	essential free, advanced paid	—	loyverse.com, 27/10/2026

Solution and tier	Price collected	Users / limits	Till	Stock	Multi-currency	Source (date)
Square (United States)	Free $0, Plus $49, Premium $149 per location per month; in-person payments 2.5% + $0.15 (Plus)	per location	yes	yes	—	Square press release, 6 October 2025
DoliCloud (hosted Dolibarr)	Basic €14 per user per month; Premium €30 + €15 per user	per user	module	yes	yes	dolicloud.com, 27/10/2026
ERPNext, Small Business plan (Frappe Cloud)	$50 a month, unlimited users	unlimited	yes	yes	yes	Frappe announcement, 14 August 2023 (old, to recheck)

Monthly cost compared for three typical profiles, zone A (annual subscription brought back to a month when the published price is annual):

Profile	Nhill (proposed)	Odoo Standard, Sub-Saharan Africa list	Zoho Books Kenya	Loyverse with employees and advanced inventory
Freelancer, 1 user	Solo: 9(7.50 on annual)	$8.95	free (under the threshold) or $6.54	$0 (till only) to $50
Shop, 5 users, 2 tills	Commerce: 25(20.83 on annual)	$44.75 (5 × $8.95)	$13.08 (no till)	$50 per store
SME, 15 users, 5 tills, 3 warehouses	SME: 59(49.17 on annual)	$134.25 (15 × $8.95)	$19.24 for 10 users (no till)	$150 for 3 stores

Reading: Nhill is **more affordable than an ERP billed per user as soon as the team has more than two or three people**, and stays close to entry prices on the market for a freelancer. Accounting-only software costs less but does not cover the till; free tills do not cover quotes, invoices and receivables.

5. Recommended business model

1. **Subscription per establishment**, with limits on users, tills and warehouses (existing mechanism); no licence per user.
2. **Monthly or annual payment**; annual gives two months (10 months paid). Quarterly (3 months, no discount) is offered in zone A, where cash cycles are short; 6, 24 and 36-month durations exist in the code but are not recommended at launch.
3. **Free assisted trial** (eight-week pilot programme, then a 30-day trial): conversion happens on real use.
4. **One-off services invoiced separately** (extra training, complex data migration, installation outside Kinshasa): prices to be set after measuring the time spent during the pilot.
5. **No paid options at launch**: the code does not handle per-unit options; the limits are enough to tell the plans apart.
6. **Two price zones** based on an objective, public criterion (World Bank classification of the establishment's country), not on a currency conversion.

6. Proposed plans and prices

Plan	For whom	Users	POS tills	Warehouses	Monthly price, zone A	Annual, zone A (10 months)	Monthly price, zone B	Annual, zone B
Solo	freelancer, solopreneur	1	1	1	$9	$90	$15	$150
Commerce	small business, shop	5	2	1	$25	$250	$39	$390
SME	SME, several sites	15	5	3	$59	$590	$89	$890
Custom	beyond 15 users, 5 tills or 3 warehouses	on quote	on quote	on quote	on quote	on quote	on quote	on quote

Database mapping (to enter in Nhill Console **after approval**): `plans` (`code` solo, commerce, pme; `max_users`, `max_registers`, `max_warehouses`, `features.multi_warehouse` true for SME, `audience` individual for Solo) and `plan_prices` (durations 1, 3 and 12 months; one row per billing currency).

7. Rationale for each price

Plan	Zone A price	Rationale
Solo	$9 a month	under the 10*threshold*; *levelwiththeOdooSub – SaharanAfricalistforoneuser*(8.95, annual) and Sage Start Kenya ($12.33); comfortably covers the cost to serve (§ 8.3); must stay a stepping stone to Commerce
Commerce	$25 a month	core plan: 5 users and 2 tills for about half the Odoo price for 5 users (44.75)*andhalfofLoyversewithemployeesandadvancedinventory*(50 per store); easy-to-read round figure; the model's ARPA centres on this plan
SME	$59 a month	multi-warehouse and 15 users: less than half the Odoo price for 15 users ($134.25); gap with Commerce clear enough for the upgrade to follow a need (warehouses, tills)
Custom	on quote	beyond the limits, integration needs or specific support
Zone B	$15, $39 and $89	same structure; well below QuickBooks ($38 to 140)*andOdooUnitedStatesperuser*(24.90 to 31.10*each*), *andabout*5537.22 against $24.02)

Tests to run during the pilot, before publication: a price-sensitivity questionnaire (Van Westendorp: too expensive, expensive, cheap, too cheap) with each pilot customer, and three different written proposals (Solo $7 / $9 / $12, Commerce $19 / $25 / $35) followed through to signature. The price kept is the one that maximises revenue per demo, not the signature rate alone.

8. Forecast budget and cost structure

8.1 Cost assumptions

Assumption	Value	Type
Hetzner CX23 application server (2 vCPU, 4 GB, 40 GB) €5.99 + 20% backups	$8.26 / month	verified
Supabase Pro managed PostgreSQL (8 GB, daily backup kept 7 days)	$25 / month	verified

Assumption	Value	Type
Encrypted off-site backups (Backblaze B2, $6.95/TB; first 10 GB free)	$1 / month	assumption
E-mail delivery (Amazon SES, $0.10 per 1,000 e-mails)	$1 / month	assumption
Domain name ($20 a year)	$1.67 / month	assumption
Windows installer signing (Azure Artifact Signing, $9.99 quoted, to be confirmed)	$9.99 / month	assumption
Tools: help desk, CRM, video calls, office suite	$45 / month	assumption
Accountant, legal and administrative fees	$150 / month	assumption
Mobile data, phone, team travel	$80 / month	assumption
Demo material, printing, small events	$150 / month	assumption
Founder pay (product, development)	$1,000 / month	assumption
Onboarding and support agent (1 per 150 active customers)	$500 / month	assumption
Active customers per support agent	150	assumption
Field sales agent, fixed pay (1 more above 12, then 24 new customers a month)	$400 / month	assumption
Sales bonus per new paying customer	$15 / new customer	assumption
Travel and material per new customer	$10 / new customer	assumption
Average collection fees (Mobile Money 2.5-3.2% via an aggregator, transfers, cards)	3.5%	assumption
Share of new customers brought by a partner	20.0%	assumption
Partner commission on the first year collected	20.0%	assumption
Share of new customers from referrals (1 month free for the referrer)	15.0%	assumption
Average discounts (promo codes, commercial gestures)	5.0%	assumption
Active establishments per application server (no load test performed)	250	assumption
Active establishments above which the database moves to larger compute (+$15/month)	500	assumption

One-off expenses:

Month	One-off expense	Amount	Type
M1	Company set-up, legal and tax advice	$1,500	assumption
M1	Demo hardware (receipt printer, scanner, Android tablet)	$1,200	assumption
M1	Google Play developer account (one-time fee)	$25	verified
M1	Printed brand material, cards, banner	$500	assumption
M6	External penetration test before a wide roll-out	$5,000	assumption

Sources of verified prices: Hetzner CX23 at €5.99 a month with IPv4 (August 2026 reading, after the 15 June 2026 price adjustment) and backups at 20% of the server price (Hetzner documentation); Supabase Pro at $25 a month (8 GB database, daily backup kept 7 days, $10 compute credit); Backblaze B2 at $6.95 per TB per month;

Amazon SES at $0.10 per 1,000 e-mails; Google Play at $25 once. The Azure Artifact Signing price is not shown on its page: $9.99 a month is the figure quoted on Microsoft's forum (October 2025), **to be confirmed**. The starting size (2 vCPU, 4 GB, 40 GB) is the one in Nhill's deployment guide.

8.2 Monthly costs of the central scenario

Item (central scenario)	Month 1	Month 12	Month 24	Month 36
Infrastructure and signing	$47	$47	$47	$55
Team	$1,900	$1,900	$2,800	$3,300
Tools, accountant, telecoms, fixed marketing	$425	$425	$425	$425
Variable acquisition (bonuses, travel, referrals)	$114	$256	$427	$598
Partner commissions	$4	$67	$127	$188
Collection fees	$14	$66	$165	$286
Total recurring costs	$2,504	$2,761	$3,991	$4,853
Monthly recurring revenue	$94	$1,669	$4,340	$7,707
Operating result	-$2,399	-$1,085	$361	$2,870

8.3 Cost to serve per customer

Cost to serve per active customer per month (central)	Month 12	Month 36
Servers, database, backups, e-mail, signing	$0.66	$0.17
Support (agents)	$6.98	$4.53
Collection fees	$0.92	$0.87
Total	$8.56	$5.57
Average revenue per account (ARPA)	$23.31	$23.29

Infrastructure costs less than a dollar per customer per month; the cost to serve depends mostly on support time. **Major unknown**: no load test has been run; the number of establishments per server (250) is a cautious assumption to replace with a measurement before 100 customers.

9. Break-even

Fixed costs of a typical month: founder, one onboarding agent, one sales agent, infrastructure, tools, accountant, telecoms, fixed marketing. Contribution per customer: ARPA of the central mix, after discounts, minus collection fees.

Price zone	ARPA (central mix, after discounts)	Fixed costs of a typical month	Contribution per customer	Active customers to break even
A (launch)	$24.89	$2,372	$24.02	99
B	$38.57	$2,372	$37.22	64

Formula: customers needed = fixed costs ÷ (ARPA × (1 – collection fees)). Above 150 customers, a second onboarding agent (+$500) raises the threshold by about 21 customers in zone A.

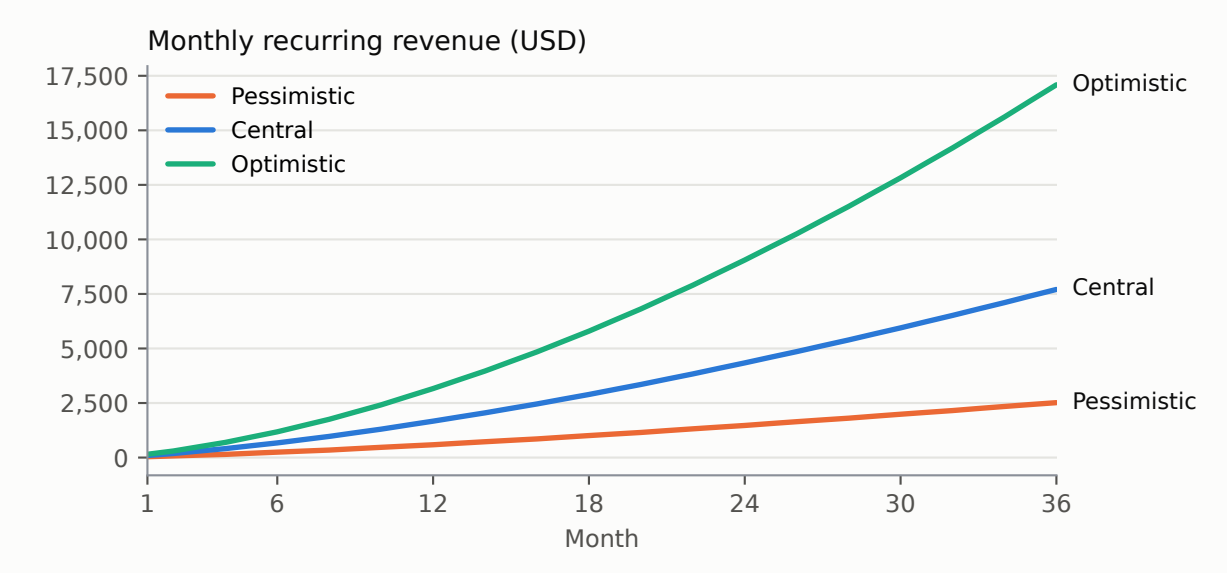
10. Financial scenarios over 36 months

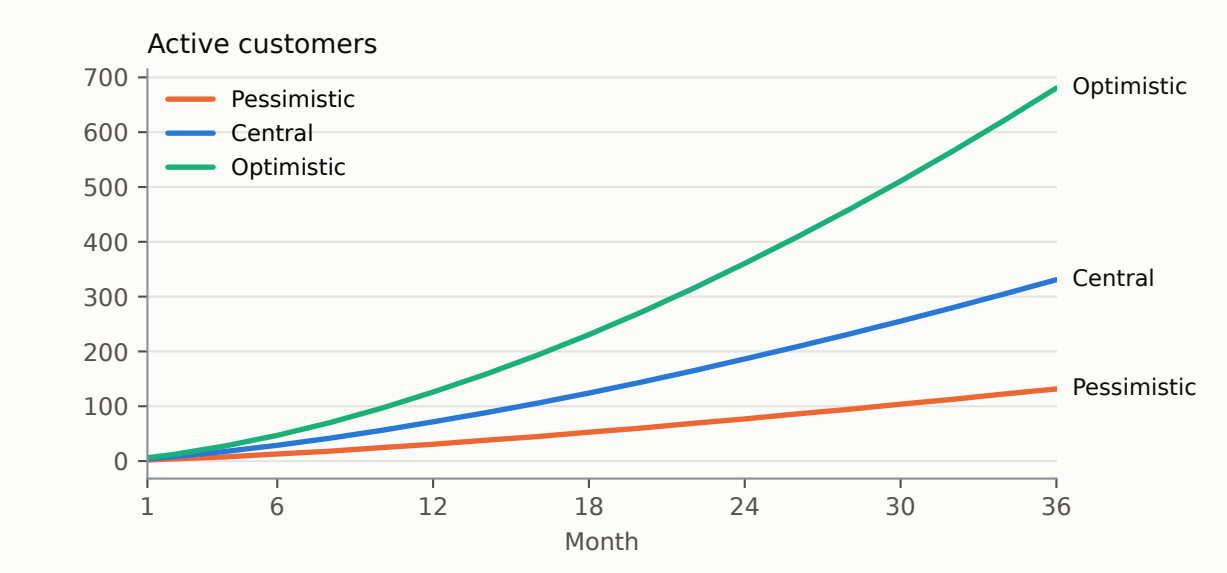
Month 1 is the first month of sales after the pilot (date to be set). Parameters:

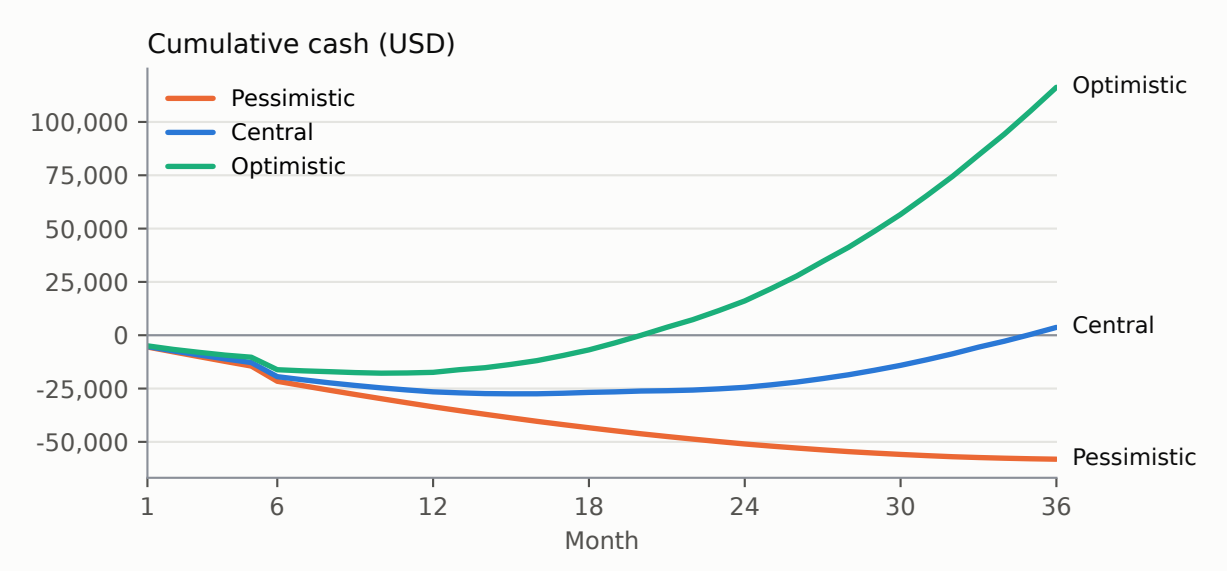
Parameter	Pessimistic	Central	Optimistic
New paying customers in month 1	2	4	6
Growth	+1 every 4 months	+1 every 2 months	+2 every 2 months
Monthly cap on new customers	10	25	45
Monthly churn	5%	3%	2%
Solo / Commerce / SME split	45 / 45 / 10%	35 / 45 / 20%	30 / 45 / 25%
Share of annual subscriptions	25%	35%	45%

Results:

Indicator	Pessimistic	Central	Optimistic
Active customers, month 12	31	72	126
Active customers, month 24	77	186	361
Active customers, month 36	132	331	681
Monthly recurring revenue (MRR), month 12	$586	$1,669	$3,163
Monthly recurring revenue (MRR), month 24	$1,471	$4,340	$9,055
Monthly recurring revenue (MRR), month 36	$2,517	$7,707	$17,087
Annual recurring revenue (ARR), month 36	$30,199	$92,478	$205,047
Average revenue per account (ARPA), month 36	$19 / month	$23 / month	$25 / month
Month of lasting operating break-even	not reached in 36 months	M23	M15
Maximum cash need (cumulative low point)	$58,126 in month 36	$27,472 in month 15	$17,789 in month 10
Cumulative cash, month 36	-$58,126	$3,683	$116,258
Average acquisition cost (CAC)	$125	$96	$83
Gross margin (collection, servers, support)	48%	72%	78%
Customer lifetime value (LTV)	$182	$556	$978
LTV / CAC	1.4	5.8	11.8
CAC payback	13.8 months	5.8 months	4.2 months
Demos needed in month 12	20	45	80







Sensitivity of the central scenario:

Variant of the central scenario	Break-even month	Maximum cash need	Cumulative cash, month 36
Central scenario as is	M23	$27,472	$3,683
Prices –20%	M27	$34,596	-$21,378
Prices +20%	M16	$24,161	$28,744
Churn 4% a month	M24	$28,034	-$2,863
Founder unpaid for 36 months	M13	$14,690	$39,683
Self-hosted database (2nd CX23 instead of Supabase)	M23	$27,221	$4,286

Reading: price and churn weigh the most; prices 20% lower push break-even back by four months and leave cash negative in month 36. The founder's pay is the main short-term cash lever. The database choice (Supabase or self-hosted server) changes the result little; it is decided on reliability and operating time.

11. Multi-currency and international strategy

11.1 Three distinct notions

Notion	Recommended rule	What exists in the code
Display currency	the currency of the written proposal and of the subscription screen is **the billing currency chosen**; the website shows no price	prices stored per currency in `plan_prices`; no conversion on display
Billing currency	chosen at sign-up among the published lists (USD everywhere; EUR; CDF in the DRC; XAF or XOF in the CEMAC and WAEMU zones; KES and RWF when those countries open); unchanged until renewal	a subscription order carries its currency; the payment provider declares the currencies it accepts
Conversion	never silent: an invoiced amount is not converted; non-USD lists are **derived** from the USD list by a published rule; internal reports consolidate in USD at the payment-date rate	lists entered in the console; platform reports per currency

11.2 Rule for deriving price lists

Local price = USD price × reference rate, rounded to a round price (CDF 500; XAF/XOF 100; €1; KSh 10). Reference rate: BCC for CDF, the fixed euro / CFA franc rate through EUR, otherwise the country's central bank. **Quarterly** review, or earlier if the rate moves more than 5% from the last review; subscribers keep their price until renewal; any change is announced 30 days ahead. Example (BCC rate of 26/10/2026, CDF 2,264): Commerce $25 ≈ CDF 56,600 → **CDF 56,500** a month.

Zone B: USD and EUR lists set as **market prices** (same figures, 15 / 39 / 89), not as conversions; GBP and CHF when those markets open.

11.3 Collection: what is ready and what is not

Method	State	Recommendation
Bank transfer, Mobile Money to the publisher's account, confirmed in the console	usable from launch (payment instructions, order validated by the administrator)	launch method in zone A

Method	State	Recommendation
Mobile Money aggregator (for example pawaPay: DRC collection 2.5% M-Pesa, 3% Orange, 3.2% Airtel, “remittance” page, enterprise contract)	**no adapter**; the generic adapter requires the aggregator to call Nhill’s signed format	build a dedicated adapter (estimate H: 2 to 4 weeks) before 100 customers
Card via Stripe	adapter written, **not verified** against the real API; the DRC is not in Stripe’s country list (“global” page: in Africa, Côte d’Ivoire, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria and South Africa, through Paystack); in the United States: 2.9% + $0.30, +1.5% international card, +1% conversion, +0.7% Stripe Billing	only announce cards after a real control payment, and only with an eligible entity
PayPal	adapter written, not verified; availability for a seller established in the DRC not confirmed	to check before any commitment

Taxes: prices proposed **excluding tax**; a VAT rate per plan exists (`tax_rate_bp`). The VAT treatment of a software subscription in the DRC (16% in the CD profile) and of sales abroad must be validated with a tax adviser before the first invoice.

11.4 Compliance per country (before opening zone B)

France as an example: receiving e-invoices is mandatory for every business from 1 September 2026, issuing them from 1 September 2026 for large and mid-size companies and from 1 September 2027 for SMEs and micro-enterprises (service-public.gouv.fr, updated 27 February 2026); till software used by VAT-registered businesses must meet conditions of inalterability, security, retention and archiving (article 286 I 3° bis of the French tax code), shown by a certificate or by the publisher’s individual attestation (ministerial answer of 10 March 2026). Nhill does not meet these requirements today: a market such as France needs a dedicated compliance project. The first target countries should also be chosen on this criterion.

12. Marketing plan and acquisition strategy

Principle: relationship-based acquisition, with no aggressive advertising, consistent with the pilot programme and the partner model (documents 02 and 09).

Lever	Implementation	Indicator	Cost in the model
Demos on the prospect’s products (main bet)	targeted field prospecting in Kinshasa (segments A and B in document 01), 45-minute demo, assisted trial	demos per week, demo → trial rate, trial → customer rate	sales agent ($400 + $15 per customer), $10 travel per customer
Partners (accountants, IT resellers, trade associations, incubators)	written agreement, 20% commission on the first year collected	customers brought per active partner	20% of year 1 for 20% of customers
Referrals	one month free for the referrer (promo code for new customers, existing mechanism)	share of referred customers	one month of ARPA for 15% of customers
International inbound presence	optimised bilingual website, listings on software directories, short content on LinkedIn and WhatsApp, video-call demos	demo requests from outside the DRC	fixed marketing $150 a month
Proof	pilot case studies, only with their written agreement, with no unmeasured figures	—	—

Volume targets derived from the central scenario: 9 new customers in month 12, so **45 demos a month** with the conversion assumptions (demo → trial 50%, trial → customer 40%, H); 21 customers in month 36. Replace these rates with the pilot's as soon as they are measured.

13. Risks, assumptions and recommendations

Risk	Effect	Response
Willingness to pay below the assumptions	later break-even (prices −20%: M27)	pilot price tests before publication; Solo plan as the entry door
Free offers (Odoo one application, Zoho Books free, Loyverse)	pressure on Solo	sell the complete tool and the support; do not take Solo below $7 without measurement
High churn	LTV divided (pessimistic: LTV/CAC 1.4)	support during the first 90 days, usage follow-up, annual encouraged
Difficult collection (manual Mobile Money, cards unavailable in the DRC)	delays, unpaid invoices, time spent	aggregator adapter before 100 customers; quarterly and annual
CDF depreciation	revenue in CDF eroded	USD reference list, quarterly review of the CDF list
Tax compliance per country	closed market (France) or risk for the customer	zone B country by country after analysis; transparency in the documentation
Unknown technical capacity	costs or incidents as volume grows	load test before 100 customers; monitoring
Security (no external penetration test)	trust, liability	penetration test budgeted in month 6
Dependence on the founder	continuity	documentation, trained onboarding agent, sustainable delivery pace
Team cost assumptions	sensitive result	enter the real budget in the script, rerun the scenarios

Assumptions to validate first: real salaries, support time per customer, pilot conversion, real collection fees, VAT treatment, capacity per server, legal entity and accessible payment methods.

Recommendations:

1. Approve the structure (three plans + custom, subscription per establishment, annual at 10 months); keep the prices as test assumptions until the end of the pilot.
2. Launch in zone A (DRC, then French-speaking low and lower-middle income countries); open zone B only after a compliance analysis per country.
3. Collect manually at launch, build the Mobile Money adapter before 100 customers, only announce cards after a real control payment.
4. Plan funding of at least **28, 000 * * (*centralscenario*)*andamarginforthepessimisticscenario*(58,000 over 36 months), or reduce fixed costs at the start.
5. Review the study every quarter with real figures (rerun the script).

14. Prioritised launch action plan

Priority	Action	Owner	Indicative deadline	Condition
1	Approve the plan structure and price zones	product owner	week 1	—

Priority	Action	Owner	Indicative deadline	Condition
1	Price questionnaire and three test proposals during the pilot	sales team	pilot (8 weeks)	pilot customers recruited
1	Validate VAT, legal entity, payment accounts	product owner, tax adviser	before the first invoice	—
2	Enter the plans and price lists in Nhill Console (without publishing them on the website)	platform administrator	after approval	prices approved
2	Load test and monitoring	technical team	before 100 customers	—
2	Mobile Money aggregator adapter (real test)	technical team	before 100 customers	aggregator contract
2	Recruit and train the onboarding agent and the sales agent	product owner	month 1	funding
3	Partner and referral programme (promo codes)	sales team	month 2	written agreements
3	External penetration test	product owner	month 6	budget
3	Compliance analysis of the first zone B country	product owner, local lawyer	after 12 months	break-even in sight
4	Possible publication of prices on the website	product owner	after explicit approval	pilot results

15. Sources

Consulted on 26 and 27 October 2026 unless stated.

Topic	Source
Odoo (prices, United States, promotion and renewal)	ERP Research — Odoo pricing (prices “as of July 2026”); Cybrosys — Odoo pricing
Odoo (regional lists)	OEC.sh — Odoo pricing 2026 (“last verified October 18, 2026”); official page odoo.com/pricing not readable by our tools
Odoo (implementation costs, United States and Canada)	Octura Solutions, 18 April 2026
Zoho Books, Zoho Inventory	Zoho Books US; Zoho Books Kenya; Zoho Inventory
QuickBooks Online	quickbooks.intuit.com/pricing
Sage Accounting Africa	sage.com/africa — pricing
Loyverse	loyverse.com/pricing
Square	Square — unified pricing, 6 October 2025
DoliCloud	dolicloud.com — pricing
ERPNext	Frappe — Small Business plan, 14 August 2023
Hetzner	15 June 2026 increase; August 2026 comparison; CX23; Hetzner billing FAQ
Supabase	supabase.com/pricing

Topic	Source
Backblaze B2	backblaze.com — pricing
Amazon SES	aws.amazon.com/ses/pricing
Google Play	Play Console Help
Azure Artifact Signing	pricing page (amounts not shown); Microsoft Q&A, October 2025
Stripe	stripe.com/pricing; stripe.com/global
pawaPay	pawapay.io/fees
Payments in the DRC	CartDNA — DRC payment guide
DRC economy	IMF, country report No. 26/2 (January 2026); Financial Afrik, 28 April 2026; Trading Economics — USD/CDF; BCC (document 01, S3)
USD/KES rate	Pound Sterling Live, 26 October 2026
World Bank classification	Afridigest, 8 July 2026
France: e-invoicing	service-public.gouv.fr, updated 27 February 2026
France: till software	Assemblée nationale, question No. 10352, answer of 10 March 2026
DRC market (MSMEs)	document 01 of this file, sources S1 to S5

16. Reproducing the calculations

```
python3 marketing/tools/subscription_model.py          # regenerates tables, CSV, JSON, charts
python3 marketing/tools/subscription_model.py --check  # checks that this document is up to
date
```

Outputs: `marketing/data/etude-abonnements/scenarios-mensuels.csv` (36 months × 3 scenarios), `resultats.json` (assumptions and summary), charts `marketing/visuals/etude-abonnements/*.svg`. To test other prices or costs, change `PLANS`, `HYP` or `SCENARIOS` in the script, then rerun it.

17. Decisions still to be approved

1. Plan structure (Solo, Commerce, SME, custom) and their limits.
2. Zone A prices ($9 / $25 / $59) as test assumptions, then final prices after the pilot.
3. The two-zone principle and the World Bank criterion; opening date of zone B.
4. Annual at 10 months; quarterly without discount in zone A.
5. Billing currencies at launch (USD, CDF) and the review rule.
6. Collection methods at launch, Mobile Money aggregator, entity for cards.
7. Team budget and funding (at least $28,000 in the central scenario).
8. Publishing prices on the website: **no**, until your explicit agreement.